

EROL OYTUN ERCAN

J. Mack Robinson College of Business, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

e-mail: eercan1@gsu.edu

EDUCATION

Georgia State University , Atlanta, GA Ph.D. in Finance, J. Mack Robinson College of Business	Expected: May 2028
Istanbul Bilgi University , Istanbul, Türkiye M.Sc. in Financial Economics	June 2023
Marmara University , Istanbul, Türkiye B.A. in Political Science and International Relations, <i>Valedictorian</i>	June 2019
Sciences Po Grenoble , Grenoble, France Erasmus Student Exchange	2017–2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fintech: Generative AI, Textual Analysis, Agentic AI, Large Language Models

Corporate Finance: Corporate Innovation, Executive Compensation, Corporate Governance

WORKING PAPERS

Taking Stock: Do Equity-Based Managerial Incentives Drive Corporate Innovation?

(with Mark Chen and Yaswanth Pothuru)

We provide causal evidence on the effects of equity-based CEO incentive pay on corporate innovation activity. To capture exogenous variation in equity-based pay, we exploit a large sample of public-company relative performance share plans under which realized equity payouts vary discontinuously around performance cutoffs. Using a regression discontinuity research design, we find that CEO stock award payouts lead to significant increases in a firm's patenting activity. Moreover, these stock award payouts increase the originality, quality, and value of a firm's patents. We also document that payout-induced increases in innovation activity are more pronounced in the presence of managerial short-termism or restrictions on selling, hedging, or pledging of shares. Overall, our findings show that equity-based pay for top management is an important driver of corporate innovation.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Value of Insider Selling: Trading Flexibility, Managerial Incentive Design and Innovation

I study whether restrictions on insider selling affect managerial incentive design by exploiting the SEC's 2022 amendments to Rule 10b5-1. I construct firm-level measures of pre-amendment insider-trading restrictions from corporate disclosures. Using a difference-in-differences design, I compare firms that were relatively less restrictive before the amendments with firms whose pre-existing policies already incorporated many of the restrictions introduced by the SEC.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgia State University

Instructor

- FI 3300 Corporate Finance, Undergraduate Fall 2025/Spring 2026
 - Taught two semesters (two sections per semester)
 - Teaching Evaluation Average: 4.3/5.0

Graduate Teaching Assistant

- FI 8092 AI and Machine Learning Applications in Finance, Graduate Level Spring 2026

SERVICE

Organizational assistance, 2025 Georgia State University-Management Science AI and FinTech Conference 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aposto, Istanbul, Türkiye Mar. 2022–Jul. 2022
Lead Finance Editor

Bloomberg HT, Istanbul, Türkiye Aug. 2019–Mar. 2022
Research Editor

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ph.D. Travel Grant, American Finance Association 2026

Doctoral Student Travel Grant, Georgia State University 2026

Ph.D Teaching Fellowship, Georgia State University 2025-2026

M.Sc. Full Scholarship, Istanbul Bilgi University 2021

Valedictorian, B.A. in Political Science and International Relations, Marmara University 2019

European Union Erasmus Scholarship, Sciences Po Grenoble 2017-2018

SKILLS

Programming: R, Stata, Python, SAS

Software: Bloomberg Terminal, Codex, Claude Code

Languages: Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)

REFERENCES

Mark Chen

Professor of Finance
J. Mack Robinson College of Business
Georgia State University
machen@gsu.edu

Baozhong Yang

H. Talmage Dobbs Jr. Chair and Professor of Finance
J. Mack Robinson College of Business
Georgia State University
bzyang@gsu.edu